

Find your building's waste in 20 minutes.

You don't need a vendor to start. You need one recent electric bill, your phone, and a walk to the roof. **This worksheet works whether or not you ever call us:** by the end you'll know where your money is leaking, and you'll be immune to the next savings pitch that can't answer these questions.

PART 1 • THE BILL TEARDOWN

~8 MINUTES, AT YOUR DESK

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- ☐ **Find your demand charge.** Look for "demand," "kW," or "peak kW" on the bill.

Amount: \$_____ • % of total bill: _____

Your single highest 15-minute spike sets this price for the whole month, no matter how low you run the rest of the time. **Over 25% of the bill = your biggest lever is the spike, not the usage.**

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- ☐ **Look for a power factor or reactive charge.** Words like "PF adjustment," "kVAR," or "reactive demand."

Present? Y / N • \$_____

A penalty for how your equipment draws power. **If it's on the bill, it's usually one of the cheapest things to make disappear.**

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- ☐ **Estimate your cooling share.** Pull your highest summer bill and your lowest winter bill.

July \$_____ - Jan \$_____ = \$_____

The difference is roughly what temperature costs you. In most commercial buildings, heating and cooling runs 40 to 50% of the total.¹ **The bigger this number, the bigger your fastest fix.**

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- ☐ **Find your rate schedule name.** Usually near the account number ("Schedule GS-2," "TOU-8," etc.).

Schedule: _____

This one word determines which utility rebate programs your building can tap. Many cover 50 to 75% of efficiency projects, and most buildings never claim them.²

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- ☐ **Check the trend.** Same month, last year vs this year. Change: _____%

A bill creeping up with no change in operations is the classic signature of equipment quietly losing efficiency.

Can't find one of these lines? That's normal; commercial bills are built to be skimmed past. Text a photo of the bill to the number below and we'll mark it up for you, no meeting required.

PART 2 · THE ROOF WALK

~12 MINUTES, WITH YOUR PHONE

- ☐ **Count your rooftop units.** Count : _____

Each one is its own patient. A 6-unit building and a 40-unit building differ in scale, not method.

- ☐ **Photograph the nameplate on each unit.** The metal data plate on the side: get the model number, tonnage, and manufacture date in one photo.

This is the single most valuable thing you can walk away with. Age, size, and type determine what any honest fix is worth. **Units 8+ years old are usually carrying the most recoverable waste.**¹

- ☐ **The listen test.** Stand by a running unit for five minutes. Does the compressor (the loud hum) ever stop, or does it run the whole time? Runs nonstop: Y / N

Once coils are saturated, the air can't get colder, yet the compressor keeps running. That's paid-for electricity doing nothing. **A compressor that never rests is the sound of the waste itself.**

- ☐ **Look at the coils.** The radiator-like fins. Dark staining, oil streaks, or a greasy film? Y / N

Compressors slowly leak oil that bakes onto coils as an insulating film, growing for years with nobody to flag it. Old units can be down as much as a third of their original heat transfer.¹

- ☐ **Ask the person who fixes them.** One question for your HVAC contractor: "Which units do you get called to most?"

Problem units: _____

Repeat-offender units are usually the ones running hardest against the most waste. (Whatever happens next, your contractor stays your contractor; we prefer working through them.)

PART 3 · SCORE IT

~30 SECONDS

Count your marks: demand charge over 25% · power factor penalty present · big summer/winter gap · bill creeping up · units 8+ years old · a compressor that never rests · stained coils.

THE READING

0–1 marks: your building is running tight; keep this sheet for next year. **2 marks:** worth a look. **3 or more:** your building is very likely a candidate for a no-cost diagnosis, and here's the part you've already done: **the bill and the nameplate photos in your hand are the entire ask.** Email or text them and The Exam starts; nothing is installed unless the savings are proven first, or you owe nothing.²

Send what you found, or ask a question.

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1. Typical shares, ranges, and equipment behaviors are representative figures from public sources and site studies, not a prediction for your building. 2. "No cost," diagnosis, and guarantee statements describe the diagnosis and pilot phase for qualifying properties and are governed by written agreement. Full numbered disclosures at the link. This worksheet is general information, not engineering advice; stay safe on the roof. © 2026 Energy Plus, Independent Energy Solutions Partner.



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